

GENDER

Ali Vs. Asmita

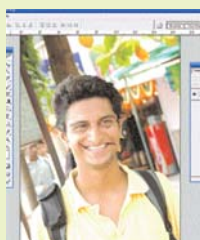


BENDERS

Use Photoshop filters to give an image a funny look



"Ali started off well—he seemed to know his Photoshop. He was directly on to the filters and rapidly went through them, choosing, applying, and then undoing effects. In a few minutes he had changed some colours, blurred the image, and crystallised it quite a number of times. He obviously didn't know which filter would do what. We gave him a pointer: that the "Liquefy" filter might be useful. Ali was quickly on to it, and using the "forward warp," he



managed to pull the cheeks and the ears out. After looking at his work for a couple of minutes, he decided he had done enough.

She took a cursory look at the filters, but Asmita seemed to like the colours better. She spent quite a bit of time painting the image red and sometimes brown, toggling between the two. Her favourite colours perhaps. She



wasn't, however, doing what she was supposed to—try to change the image. Once she'd been reminded, she had a good look at the filters again and decided to use the "Liquefy > Bloat" tool to give the image a bulged-eye look. The hair underwent some changes. Asmita just wouldn't give up on the colours—there had to be the red on the lips before she stopped!



Cuban had said in September, "Only a moron would buy YouTube." So what does that tell us? We aren't clear either.

COP-OUT

Time Goes Ga-Ga About Web 2.0

They probably expected such sneers, and they probably didn't care.

Time Magazine has gone on to name participants in the inexplicable experiment

called Web 2.0—including "you"—as the People of the Year. This is a cop-out of a major order.

Lev Grossman of *Time* waxes eloquent: "It's a story about community and collaboration on a scale never seen before. It's about the cosmic compendium of knowledge Wikipedia and the million-channel people's network YouTube and the online metropolis MySpace." Wikipedia is an event of the year? Seriously, we're all avid users of Wikipedia, but when it comes to naming something of global importance we must point out, we've had

Encyclopaedia Britannica for centuries. As for YouTube, you can comment on it being a groundbreaking event as easily as we can.

MySpace users, incidentally, are 55 per cent American. "You can learn more about how Americans live just by looking at the backgrounds of YouTube videos than you could from 1,000 hours of network television." Mr Grossman, we beg to remind you that the world is *not* American.

Are blogs revolutionising the world? Some people seem to think they're doing something revolutionary when they're creating something the world can see, but the problem is, it's a cacophony of voices (in which each possibly has merit). Whichever way, what does Web 2.0 have to do with it?

The whole thing smacks of wasted eloquence: "We also worked like crazy. We reviewed books at Amazon and recorded podcasts. We blogged about our candidates losing and wrote songs about getting dumped. We camcordered bombing runs and built open-source software." In much of the above, what's to do with Web 2.0? And in any case, would you read a blog about someone getting dumped—something that, in Grossman's opinion, is revolutionising things? Is it "changing the way the world changes"? Are the book reviews at Amazon.com more credible than those you can read in *The New York Times*? Seriously, again, does Web 2.0 have the will to change the world, is our question.

Grossman excuses himself with "Web 2.0 harnesses the stupidity of crowds as well as its wisdom," going on to say, "That's what makes all this interesting." We are therefore to gather that something interesting—rather than something or somebody edifying—is to hold our collective attention.

But yes, Web 2.0 is interesting. However, that's where it should end. At least when you're talking on a global scale.

SOCIALISM, ANYONE?

First Splogs, Now Phony Stories

Marketers are in line to boost their companies' profiles at the expense of Digg. This rather interesting news story doesn't, at first look, seem to hold much: it starts off, "Digg continues to crack down on users who plant phony stories on behalf of marketers." The story goes like this: Digg recently deleted a user who posted a story about a company that offered to pay him. Karim Yergaliyev is one of Digg's top-rated users. Yergaliyev was booted for violating the company's terms of service, but was reinstated after he acknowledged the infraction, apologised nicely, and promised never to do it again.

"I receive two or three offers from marketers a week to promote some product or service,"

AMD Quad FX

The hottest tech talk on the Internet now is, of course, about cores. AMD has officially announced its Quad FX Platform, in which a pair of AMD Athlon 64 FX series dual-core processors can be used together on a supporting motherboard. This dual-socket platform enables use of four cores for megatasking—use of multiple displays or running multithreaded applications such as games, while running other processes like disc burning and so on.

Power consumption is much higher than an equivalent Intel system, though. Some forums are talking about an upgrade possibility—using eight cores on the platform after the release of AMD's quad-core chips. Some experts believe there isn't any potential in hooking up more than two cores, and that there will not be any performance boosts with new titles. In any case, the battle of the multiple cores continues...

Buzzword
of the MONTH